

Powering a city

Interconnected power lines deliver electricity over large distances. Uncovered cables are suspended high above the ground on poles and towers where they do not present a hazard to people.

The world's
tallest electricity
pylon is in China
and reaches a height
of **1,214 ft**
(370 m).

How current travels

The pressure that pushes electricity to travel through wires and cables is called voltage. The higher the voltage, the less energy is lost from resistance as the current travels through the power lines. At the power station, a device called a transformer increases the voltage. As it leaves the grid, another transformer decreases the voltage.

